# ARTEMIS II

**By Lanthano** **4/4/2026**

WHAT IS ARTEMIS? The Artemis program is a space program led by NASA that aims to return humans to the Moon and establish a long-term presence there. It builds on the earlier Apollo program and is designed to prepare for future missions to Mars.

Artemis II is the first crewed mission in the Artemis program, led by NASA. Its main purpose is to send astronauts on a trip around the Moon and safely return them to Earth.

The mission will use the Space Launch System to launch the Orion spacecraft with a crew of four astronauts. Unlike later missions, Artemis II will not land on the Moon. Instead, it will perform a lunar flyby, traveling farther from Earth than any human mission since the Apollo era.

The goals of Artemis II are to:

- Test life-support systems with astronauts onboard
- Evaluate the Orion spacecraft's performance in deep space
- Demonstrate safe crew operations during a long-duration mission

This mission is a critical step before Artemis III, which is planned to land astronauts on the Moon.

But now we are going to look into the mission, and see if it could possibly be a fabrication.

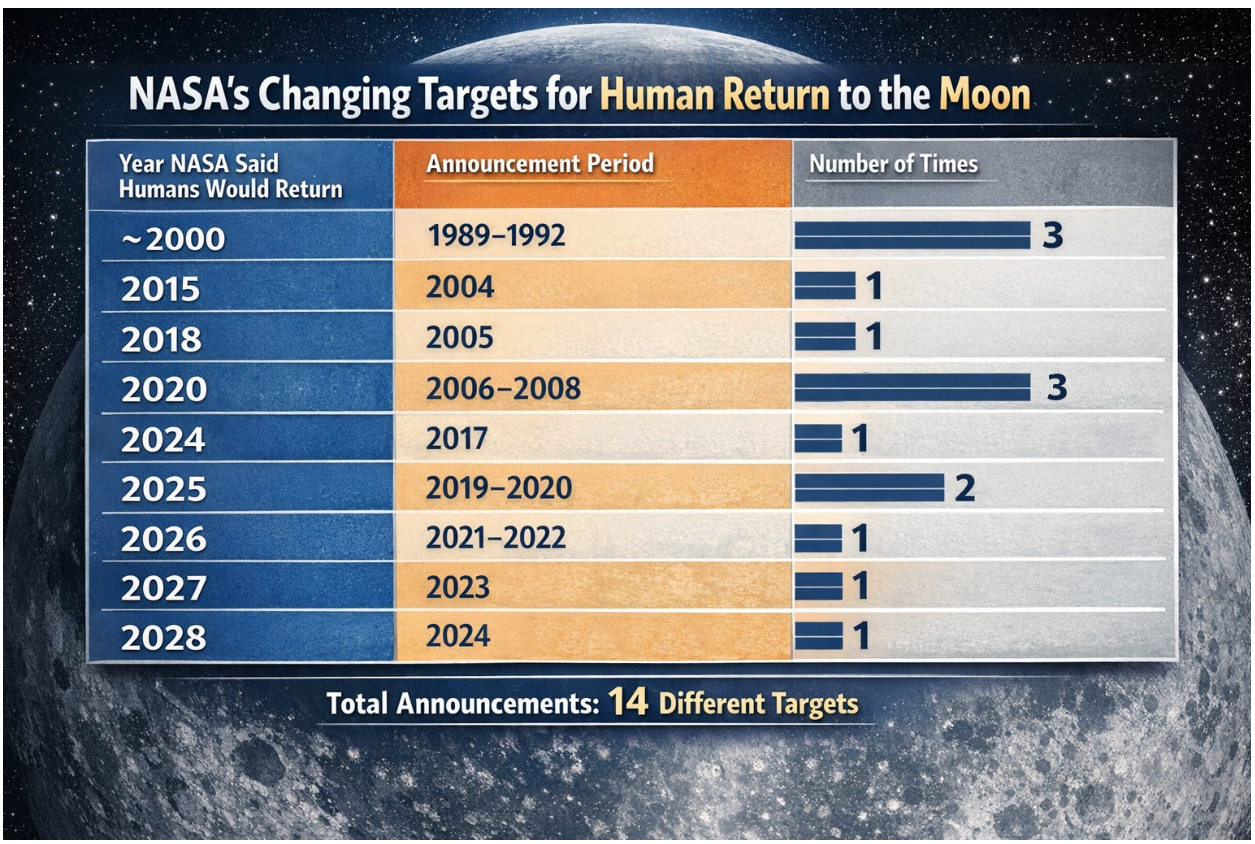
This paper is a look into NASA's moon missions involving human passengers in the 21st century. For the moon missions of the 1960s and 70s, please reference the following paper: *The Moon Hoax*, by Lanthano: https://drive.proton.me/urls/35CYMZCFW8#5GI4ETZoukIb

## CHANGING TARGET

Over the past several decades, projected timelines for returning humans to the Moon have shifted repeatedly, reflecting changing priorities, funding realities, and technical challenges. In the late 1980s and early 1990s, early post-Apollo planning efforts suggested that a return could occur around the year 2000. This expectation was discussed multiple times during that period, but it was not supported by sustained funding or a fully developed program, and the goal ultimately passed without execution.

In the early 2000s, a renewed push for lunar exploration emerged. In 2004, a new initiative set a target of 2015, aiming to reestablish human presence beyond low Earth orbit. However, this timeline was quickly adjusted in 2005, when the target shifted to 2018 as planning realities became clearer. Between 2006 and 2008, the projected return was further delayed to 2020, reflecting ongoing technical development issues, budget constraints, and evolving mission architectures. Despite these revisions, the 2020 goal was not met.

A more recent phase of planning began in the late 2010s, with a target of 2024 announced as part of a renewed lunar program. This date was later extended to 2025 in subsequent updates around 2019 and 2020, as program complexity and development timelines became more apparent. Continued adjustments followed, with projections moving to 2026 during the early 2020s, then to 2027, and most recently to 2028. These successive revisions illustrate a consistent pattern in which ambitious initial timelines are later extended due to a combination of technological hurdles, budgetary limitations, and the inherent difficulty of human spaceflight beyond Earth orbit.



## PHOTOGRAPHIC ANOMALIES

This is an image taken during Artemis II on April 3rd. Here's what NASA says on their website:

> **NASA astronaut and Artemis II Commander Reid Wiseman took this picture of Earth from the Orion spacecraft's window after completing the translunar injection burn. There are two auroras (top right and bottom left) and zodiacal light (bottom right) is visible as the Earth eclipses the Sun.**[A1]

While NASA does not give a published distance from earth for this photograph. The distance can be estimated fairly precisely by calculating Earth's angular size from the image. This method gives us a distance of around miles from earth.

Since Artemis has published it's distance from earth during the whole trip, we can take the date and estimate the distance. On April the 3rd, Artemis would be anywhere between 30,000 and 50,000 miles from Earth.

The first method is sketchy because we don't have the metadata from the original image. But, pairing the two methods, we find a roughly consistent number of about 30,000 to 46,000 miles.

### CITY LIGHTS

The farthest from earth that the human eye can see city lights is 300 to 400 miles from earth. For a camera the maximum is about 1,000 to 2,000 miles. After that, the lights given off from cities are to dispersed to be captured. After 2,000 miles, no light is realistically visible. By 10,000 miles, even the theoretical runs out and no city lights would be visible.

Looking at the Artemis image, we have a problem. The photograph shows city lights. If it is at a minimum of 30,000 miles away from earth, city lights are an impossibility in this image.

If someone wants to argue that those are not city lights, then they can contend with this image from the same region at night.

## FALSE ARGUMENTS

This part will focus on the arguments you might here people use against Artemis II as proof it's fake. But these aren't solid arguments at all.

### JUST DARKEN IT

Here you can see the two images (both official NASA photos taken directly from NASA's website), side by side. They appear really similar. And when you examine the stars, clouds, lights, etc. You will fin that these are the exact same image. One has been darkened, and the other untouched.

As you can see, one is a daytime photo, the other a nighttime photo. This means these are at least 12 hours apart. And over longer periods like 12 hours, these small, continuous changes accumulate (winds at different altitudes push clouds in varying directions, moisture condenses or evaporates, and pressure systems evolve) resulting in noticeable differences in position, structure, and detail. Because the atmosphere is a dynamic and chaotic system, even large, stable cloud patterns will not remain identical over that length of time.

The argument is this: when you compare these two photographs, they are the same but with the brightness changed. And thus they can't be 12 hours apart.

The official reason given for this is that both of these were taken seconds apart. And the person taking the picture was adjusting the exposure settings. So these are both nighttime photos, just one does have the brightness turned way up.

# SOURCES

Video sources in this paper are available for download from my ProtonDrive at:

* Indicates a topic or source that was uncovered with the help of an AI model (ChatGPT, Grok, etc.). The facts and sources themselves are independently studied and verified by the author. No AI model is taken at it's word.

Email TheOregonTrail@protonmail.com if you would like to ask a question, found an error throughout this paper, or have more evidence you would like to present to me (regarding either side of the debate).

## PHOTOGRAPHIC ANOMALIES

[A1] Image and quote source: https://www.nasa.gov/image-article/hello-world/?utm.com

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